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Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

MK263: Competitive Marketing Strategy (with Simulation)
Course Credits 3; MBA62; AY 2026-27; Elective Course (Term VI)

INSTRUCTOR:
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INTRODUCTION
Marketing involves a complex web of activity aimed towards creating and delivering superior value to customers, and in turn creating value for the firm. How well a firm's custodians manage each activity of this complex web of activity, and how well each of these are in sync with each other, has a very strong bearing on how successful a firm is.

Marketing managers, on a daily basis, make decisions based on their understanding of the market. These decisions get manifested through the various levers of the marketing mix among other variables of import. Learning marketing through actual decision making about these variables would help (future) decision makers learn invaluable lessons on issues involved in marketing decision making, and help appreciate the complexity of Marketing. This would also help them understand how theoretical concepts in Marketing manifest themselves in real-life scenarios.

This simulation course provides a risk-free platform for student teams to apply their cumulative learning from Marketing courses in a competitive market scenario wherein they can test their ideas in managing a firm and its brands.

COURSE PEDAGOGY
This course will use a mix of lectures, case discussions, and simulation (using the best-in-class marketing strategy simulation), and student presentations. The two sessions for a week will be combined into one 180-minute session. Each session will include: lecture and case-based discussion on specific topics in Marketing Strategy, and debrief and discussion for each decision round of simulation.

COURSE MATERIAL
Readings, and cases will be provided as part of the course-pack along with prescribed textbook.

COURSE EVALUATION
Evaluation components for this course are:

1)	Class Participation	20%
2)	Quizzes (Announced) (5 Nos.)	40%
3)	Project (Group Activity)	40%

Project (Group Activity)
The group project in this course is the management of a firm in the simulation game by respective student teams. This component will be evaluated on two counts – (i) performance in the simulation, and (ii) learning from the simulation (captured in the form of three submissions structured around the management of said firm and its brands.)

INDICATIVE LIST OF TOPICS

- Role of Marketing Strategy in a firm
- Market Analysis
- Marketing Planning
- Pricing Strategy
- NPD Strategy
- Branding Strategy
- Communications Strategy
- Maneuvering evolving market challenges

PLEASE NOTE:

1. *You need to have "B Only" or higher grade in **both** Marketing courses (MK101 and MK102) offered in MBA first year to opt for this elective course.*
2. *Students are required to form teams of four (04) members for the group activity prior to commencement of the course. To facilitate this, the final list of students will be shared with those enrolled for the course once it is available from the MBA Office.*

EXPECTATIONS, GUIDELINES & PRACTICES:

Listed below are the expectations of participants, and some general guidelines and practices to be followed for this course. These may be added to or modified during the course to enable smooth conduct of the course.

1) It is expected that students will,
   a. read prescribed material for a session,
   b. contribute positively to all in-class activities (including discussions, presentations etc.), and to their group in group activities,
   c. be honest during quizzes, and submit original work for all submissions, whether these are individual or group submissions,
   d. maintain a level of in-class decorum befitting students of our institution.
2) In the event of academic misdemeanor, malpractice, or misconduct; including submitting plagiarized, purchased, contracted, falsified assignments, submissions, or projects, and cheating in a quiz or the exam; the relevant MBA rules will apply. The minimum penalty will be a grade of zero on that submitted material, quiz, or exam.
3) Peer-evaluation may be used for Group activities. Peer evaluation may be used either as part or whole of the evaluation and may be used for one or more group assignment/submission.
4) Differently-abled students may freely approach the instructor about any accommodations that they may require. The instructor will make all permissible accommodations with the advice of the MBA Office.